

Seven people looking for **one right car**

Buyer personas for the approved-used matcher: who they are, what they say they want, and what actually decides it. Research-informed working personas, July 2026, with every source audited and scored for trust. These pages describe the people; how the tool performs for them is reported separately.

BMW



Daniel, 47
The Motorway Manager



Priya, 38
The Family Consolidator



Martin, 56
The Reward Buyer



Tyler, 27
The First-Premium Striver

MINI



Chloe, 29
The Statement Buyer



Sam & Jordan, 34
The Fun-Sized Family



Meg, 58
The Electric Downsizer

THE CONTEXT

What the research says about used-car buyers

~14 hrs

of online research before a buyer contacts anyone, peaking in the evening

What Car? survey via Wonderful.co.uk · confidence: medium

40–50 mi

the working radius buyers shop in; nearly half say they'd go further for the right car

Auto Trader marketplace data · confidence: medium-high

60%

of under-35s' research happens on a phone; over-45s still skew desktop

Meta UK via Wonderful.co.uk · confidence: medium-low

88%

call colour a key purchase factor, even though most end up in white, black, grey or silver

Axalta global colour survey · confidence: medium-high

The journey is online-first; the purchase stays local. People do the work in the evenings on their own sofa, then buy from a dealer they can reach, inside a radius of roughly forty to fifty miles. A tool anchored to one retailer, honest about what sits just beyond it, matches how buyers actually behave.

Affordability is the mood. Most buyers budget in monthly payments rather than totals, and younger buyers barely think in any other unit. **Taste decides late:** people narrow to a shortlist on facts, then choose between near-identical cars on colour and character.

The brands attract different people. BMW's approved-used buyer is established, 35–55, and buys certainty: warranty, history, no surprises. Approved used is also the brand's front door for the next generation, which is what Tyler is here to represent. MINI's buyer skews younger, urban and image-led; the Countryman exists so young families don't have to trade the statement away.

Evidence honesty: every source behind these numbers was fetched and audited on 22 July 2026; each carries the confidence score shown, and two travel-distance statistics from an earlier draft were withdrawn when their claimed source turned out not to contain them. The full audit table, with what each source was used for and why it earned its score, is in docs/personas.md. These personas are synthesised from that research plus brand positioning and this project's stock analysis; they are hypotheses to test, not interview findings.

"I've had company cars for ten years. This one's my own money, so it needs to be right."

LIFE

Regional operations director, outside Perth. Married, two teenagers.

MILES

~22,000 a year, mostly A9/M90

BUDGET

£22–38k, and he thinks in monthly outgoings too

SHOPPING FOR

Diesel or plug-in hybrid saloon/estate

DEVICE

Desktop, evenings, spreadsheet in the next tab

SAYS HE WANTS

A comfortable, frugal motorway car. Diesel by habit; hybrid-curious but no home charger yet.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

Total cost of ownership and the absence of doubt. First private purchase in a decade, which makes him the classic Approved Used customer: he is buying the warranty and the history as much as the car. He will read every line of both.

WHAT WINNING HIM OVER LOOKS LIKE

A sensible high-mileage answer with the economy argued in his terms: what this car costs to run at his mileage, and the programme's certainty stated where he can see it rather than assumed.

"If the buggy and the dog don't both fit, it doesn't matter how clever it is."

LIFE

GP in Perthshire. Two children under 8, one spaniel. Going from two cars to one.

MILES

~9,000 a year + Glasgow grandparent runs

BUDGET

£25–45k · wallbox already on the drive

SHOPPING FOR

Electric or plug-in SUV/estate

DEVICE

Mobile in stolen moments; decides on desktop with partner

SAYS SHE WANTS

An electric family car big enough for everything, safe, and honest about range.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

Whether she believes the boot claim (she thinks in buggies and dogs, not litres), ISOFIX in the back, and what the range really is on a cold motorway run to Glasgow.

WHAT WINNING HER OVER LOOKS LIKE

A shortlist she can defend to her partner: practicality reasons front and centre, honest numbers, and nothing that smells like it is hiding a compromise.

"I've spent thirty years being sensible. Not this time."

LIFE

Sold his share of an engineering firm. Kids gone. Promised himself this for twenty years.

MILES

~6,000 a year, sunny ones

BUDGET

£30–60k

SHOPPING FOR

Petrol convertible, quick enough to feel it

DEVICE

Desktop; will phone the dealer rather than fill in a form

SAYS HE WANTS

A petrol convertible. He is decisive about the shape and open-minded about almost everything else.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

How it makes him feel: the sound, the colour on his gravel drive, the test drive. Will happily travel fifty miles for the right car.

WHAT WINNING HIM OVER LOOKS LIKE

Being told straight. If the right car isn't at his local dealer, say so and say where it is; he has the time and the tank to go and get it.

"My mates rate the badge. My bank app rates the monthlies. Both have to say yes."

LIFE

Software sales, Dundee.
Commission just starting to land.
First premium car.

MILES

~12,000 a year, commute plus weekends

BUDGET

£16–24k on paper; really a monthly number and an insurance quote

SHOPPING FOR

Petrol 1 Series or 2 Series Gran Coupé, M Sport, black or white

DEVICE

Phone only, late night, YouTube and TikTok reviews running

SAYS HE WANTS

The M Sport look for the money he has. He knows the exact trims and the exact engines; the reviewers he trusts have opinions on both.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

The monthly payment his bank app tolerates and the insurance quote it doesn't. Then the colour in his building's car park. Approved used is his way into the badge, even if nobody markets it to him that way.

WHAT WINNING HIM OVER LOOKS LIKE

The right car with numbers he can say out loud: the monthly, the insurance group, the 0–62. Zero friction; one whiff of brochure-speak and he's gone.



Chloe Bennett, 29

The Statement Buyer

MINI

“It's the first car I've bought with my own money. It's not allowed to be boring.”

LIFE

Marketing manager in Luton, in London three days a week.

MILES

Low; city and station runs

BUDGET

£14–22k · budgets monthly, not in totals

SHOPPING FOR

Petrol 3-door hatch · it's a MINI or a Fiat 500

DEVICE

Entirely mobile, 9pm, Pinterest board open

SAYS SHE WANTS

A 3-door petrol MINI hatch. Classic trim is fine.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

The colour and the roof. Full stop. The one that photographs best outside her flat wins.

WHAT WINNING HER OVER LOOKS LIKE

Getting to make the final call herself, between real cars whose paint she can see, not being told which one is "best" by a spreadsheet.



Sam & Jordan Reyes, 34

The Fun-Sized Family

MINI

“Having a kid doesn't mean we have to drive something grey.”

LIFE

Graphic designer and paramedic in Luton. One toddler, an allotment, street parking.

MILES

Town miles plus weekend escapes

BUDGET

£18–30k

SHOPPING FOR

Countryman or Clubman, petrol (no charger on their street)

DEVICE

Mobile, in shifts, sending each other links: “this one?”

SAY THEY WANT

A practical MINI: buggy-and-shop boot, cheap to run, still theirs to look at.

ACTUALLY DECIDE ON

Whether the buggy fits with the weekly shop, doors that open in tight car parks, and the styling still saying MINI, which the contrast roof carries.

WHAT WINNING THEM OVER LOOKS LIKE

Practicality they believe, in their own terms, from a car that still looks like theirs in the photos.



Meg Whitlow, 58

The Electric Downsizer



“I don't want clever. I want honest, comfortable, and a plug.”

LIFE

Recently retired teacher, St Albans. Downsizing from an X1 that's too big for her life now.

MILES

Short: town, garden centre, grandchildren

BUDGET

£15–25k · wallbox fitted last spring

SHOPPING FOR

Small electric automatic, comfortable

DEVICE

Desktop, daytime, methodical. Prints things.

SAYS SHE WANTS

A small electric car with a plug she already has. Not a badge purchase; the MINI is simply the charming version of the right size.

ACTUALLY DECIDES ON

Trust. Range said plainly, heated seats and parking sensors present, an automatic gearbox confirmed rather than assumed, a dealer she can reach, a warranty page she reads twice.

WHAT WINNING HER OVER LOOKS LIKE

Plain numbers, no cleverness, and the comfort equipment stated where she can see it.